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HARDWARE



Apple iOS 26 public beta arrives

The update also brings the most notable visual transformation since iOS 7, featuring a “Liquid Glass” design that offers a more transparent, glass-like feel to user interface elements, like buttons, screens, and in-app navigation and controls, among other things. Liquid Glass is integrated throughout iOS 26, including in key apps like Phone, Camera, Safari, Music, and others, as well as in notifications, the Lock Screen, Control Center, and the Home Screen.

In terms of [AI features](#), the new software brings a [live translation feature](#) that translates conversations in real time, AI-powered shortcuts, [poll suggestions in Messages](#), and an update to Visual Intelligence for conducting image searches as you browse.



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adopted the Liquid Glass design.

Here is a brief overview of all the new features being introduced.

iOS 26

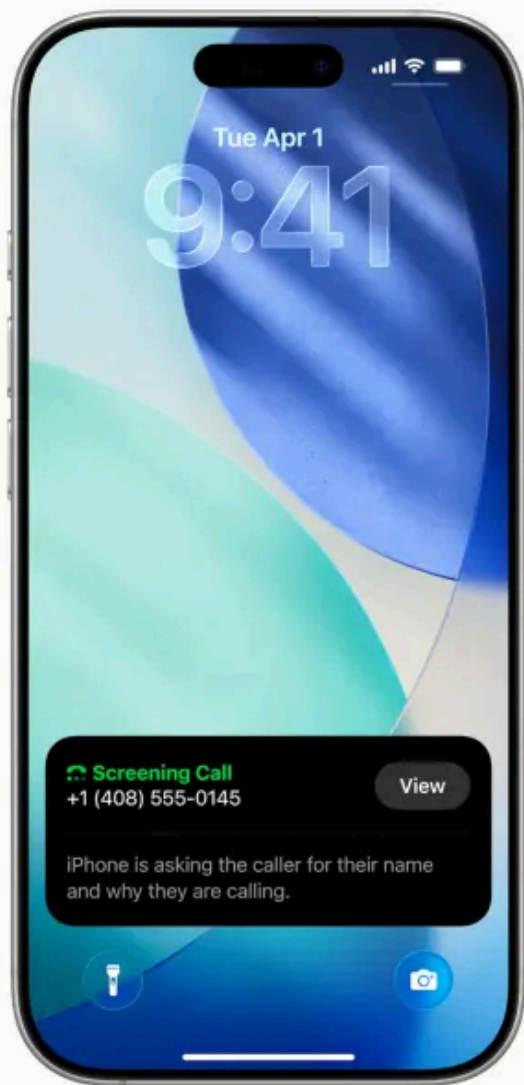


IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

In addition to the glass aesthetic, iPhone users have several updates to be excited about, including a [dedicated gaming app](#) that serves as a new destination for playing and discovering games in one place.

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The Phone app is introducing a new Call Screening feature that prompts unknown callers to state their name and reason for calling before the recipient answers. Additionally, a Hold Assist feature will notify users when hold music ends, signaling that they can speak to a live agent. The app, along with Messages and FaceTime, will also support real-time live translations. In the Messages app, meanwhile, users can expect a feature that has AI-generated suggestions for polls.

In addition, iOS 26 will bring updates to Genmoji and Image Playground, as well as [improvements](#) to Camera, Photos, Maps, [and a range of other minor additions](#), including the ability to customize alarm snooze times.

iPadOS 26

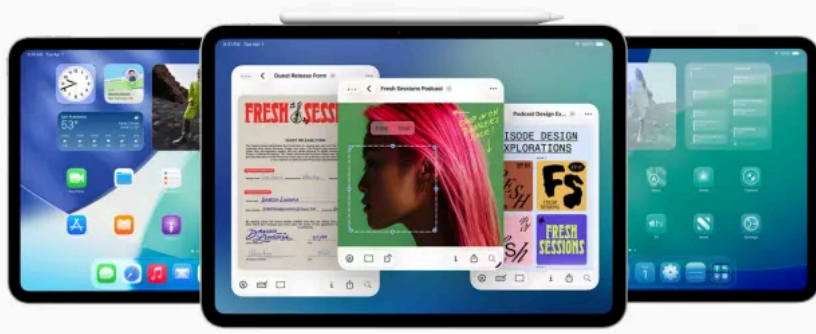


IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

A big win for iPad users is that they'll experience a more [Mac-like tablet](#). For example, iPadOS 16 is bringing the Preview app from macOS, which enables annotation on PDFs. Plus, a new windowing system that lets users adjust the size of web pages and apps, as well as manage multiple windows and tabs at once.

macOS Tahoe 26

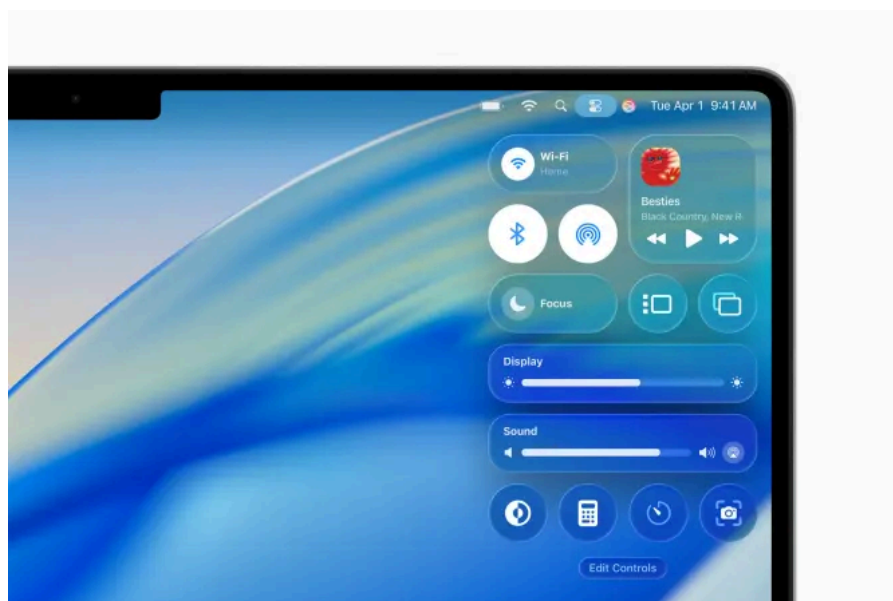


IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

One notable update for [macOS 26](#) involves Spotlight, which will employ AI to anticipate user searches and suggest actions based on frequently performed tasks or ongoing projects. Additionally, macOS is gaining Live Activities, allowing users to

sync activities directly with their iPhones and access recent calls and contacts.

watchOS 26



IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

One of the more significant features coming to the new [watchOS](#) is Workout Buddy, a fitness assistant powered by Apple Intelligence that provides motivation using a generative AI voice during workouts, pointing out key moments like closing the Exercise ring for the day.

Apple has also revamped the Workout app, introducing a helpful new option called Autoplay Media. This feature automatically starts playing music, podcasts, and audiobooks. Additionally, Apple Music can intelligently recommend the most suitable playlists for your workouts and will recall listening habits for each type of exercise.

Another update is the automatic volume adjustment capability, which adjusts the volume of calls, timers, alarms, and Siri to match the surrounding sound levels, ideal for quiet places like libraries.

Apple also introduced a new one-handed flick gesture that's designed to dismiss notifications, silence incoming calls, and return to the watch face, among other actions.

tvOS 26



IMAGE CREDITS:APPLE

Arguably, the most useful new feature coming to Apple's TV operating system is the ability to switch profiles seamlessly. Users can easily select their profile as soon as the Apple TV wakes from sleep, allowing them to quickly resume their viewing experience.

Apple Music introduced a fun feature that enables users to use their iPhones as microphones for sing-alongs, complete with on-screen lyrics displayed on the TV. Multiple iPhones can connect at once, making it possible for friends and family to join in, queue songs, and even send emoji reactions.

Additionally, new Contact Posters for FaceTime allow users to showcase customized photos and names, personalizing the experience. Another notable update includes the expansion of Live Captions to support translations in languages such as French, German, and Spanish.

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Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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IMAGE CREDITS: TECHCRUNCH



What to expect from Apple's WWDC 2022 keynote

Brian Heater — 8:56 AM PDT · June 2, 2022

First and foremost, WWDC is a developer event. Heck, it's right there in the name (Worldwide Developers Conference). Like I/O, Build and the rest, the show has traditionally been a venue for

getting a whole bunch of software devs under one roof to discuss the intricacies of the company's various platforms. Of course, the "roof" part has changed a bit during pandemic lockdowns, but the core of the show remains the same.

The company's operating systems will be the centerpiece for the week, starting with the kickoff keynote on **Monday, June 6 at 10 a.m. PT**. That means we're almost certainly going to hear the latest on iOS/iPad OS, macOS and watchOS, as well as some wildcards like tvOS.

WWDC hasn't historically been a huge event for hardware, but we've been surprised before. After all, it's well positioned between the company's spring and fall events, which makes it an ideal stage to announce some new stuff.

With all that in mind, here's what we know, what we think we know and a little wild speculation thrown in for good measure.

iOS/iPadOS 16



IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

As always, we're starting with the no-brainer here. We're definitely getting a peek at the latest version of Apple's mobile operating system. The first look at iOS 16 will likely arrive with an early developer beta — meaning if you have an Apple dev account, you

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can get access, not long after the keynote (download at your own risk, of course).

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Sarah [recently wrote about some early rumors](#) originally [published by Bloomberg](#). Per early versions of the operating system, which were produced under the code name “Sydney,” expect a fairly big upgrade here, following significant changes from iOS 14 and 15. The biggest changes are apparently in store for the lock screen, notifications, Messages and Health.

As we noted, Apple has not fully utilized the lock screen in previous upgrades. It’s really just the domain of the date and time. This update could bring some widgets to the real estate, by way of the “Today View,” including key bits of information like weather, calendar entries and shortcuts to favorite apps, beyond the existing camera and flashlight buttons. Sarah notes:



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This change could be beneficial to app developers who support widgets, as it gives them another shot

at grabbing users' attention in a high-profile area. Plus, it would give the homescreen customization app developers a way to extend their offerings. That is, users could now download full theme sets with sets of widgets designed both for the lockscreen and homescreen, along with matching wallpapers and icon themes.

The features appear to be setting the stage for a version of the iPhone 14 with the sort of always-on display currently offered on the Apple Watch and some Android handsets. You'll have to wait until the fall event to get a look at those devices, of course.

A new version of the Messages app is said to be getting more social functionality, as well as new audio messages functionality. The iPhone's Health app is also reportedly getting some new features, though those are still TBD at the time of this writing.

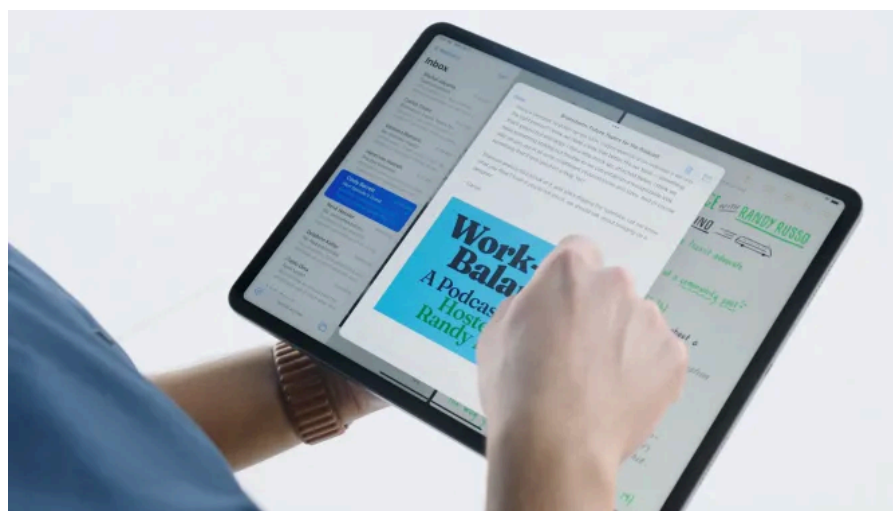


IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

iPadOS, meanwhile, could be getting [multitasking improvements](#) designed to make the tablet operating system more competitive with laptops. That could include an improvement to the way iPads handle application windows for a more desktop-style experience that could further separate the OS fork from its mobile counterpart. This could ultimately shape up to be a big year for iPadOS, which has largely been served as a kind of larger screen version of iOS since the company first

separated the two exactly three years ago, tomorrow.

Now that the iPad Pro and Air are both rocking the same M1 chip introduced for Mac, the timing is right to further unlock some of the tablets' potential here. While it's true that some have already switched from laptop to tablet, the iPad currently leaves much to be desired as a daily driver. If Apple ends broadening the devices' capabilities on that front, however, the question remains just how blurry the line will get between iPadOS and macOS, going forward.

macOS 13



IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

We're working with the extremely fun potential name Mammoth here. The potential name for lucky macOS 13 is among those for which Apple applied for a trademark some years back. In addition to



IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

Things start getting even thinner here. watchOS is expected to get some key features like new faces for the larger display, as well as an improved low power mode. Honestly, that second one is important. Battery is still a big issue with the Apple Watch compared to the competition. Hopefully software improvements coupled with a larger battery can help make the device more competitive on that front when the Series 6 rolls around.

tvOS remains a big question mark, especially after the operating system got virtually no love at last year's event, beyond the addition of spatial audio. Likely we won't see the long-rumored debut of homeOS, but tvOS will probably be getting some key home automation updates nonetheless.

Hardware



ATTENDEES VIEW NEW MACBOOK PRO LAPTOP COMPUTERS DURING AN EVENT AT APPLE INC. HEADQUARTERS IN CUPERTINO, CALIFORNIA, U.S., ON THURSDAY, OCT. 27, 2016. APPLE INC. INTRODUCED THE FIRST OVERHAUL OF ITS MACBOOK PRO LAPTOP IN MORE THAN FOUR YEARS, DEMONSTRATING DEDICATION TO A PRODUCT THAT REPRESENTS A SMALL PERCENTAGE OF REVENUE.

IMAGE CREDITS: DAVID PAUL MORRIS/BLOOMBERG VIA GETTY IMAGES

Here’s where things get (even more) fun. With the move to first-party silicon, the new Macs have been coming in hot over the last couple of years. After the release of M1 and its (many, many) subsequent iterations, word is that the newer, more powerful M2 chip is around the corner. If that happens, it will almost certainly bring new hardware. A new MacBook Air has been rumored, as has a long-awaited camera upgrade stuck inside a MacBook Air-style screen notch. Fun, if less-founded rumors have pointed to iMac-style colors for Apple’s thin and light as well.

A new Mac Pro isn’t on the list, but that would be an interesting wrinkle — especially considering what Apple would have to execute on the chip front to really pull apart from the pack. Ditto for a new version of the bygone iMac Pro.

If Apple really wants to make a splash, it will offer a glimpse at its long-rumored headset. A [trademark application](#) for realityOS seems to suggest that the combo AR/VR wearable could be announced sooner rather than later. The company has also been rumored to be showing the system off to

shareholders. All signs point to a 2023 release, however, which would mean — best-case scenario — nothing more than a “one more thing” style glimpse at what’s to come.

As ever, TechCrunch will be bringing the news to you as it happens.



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Brian Heater

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Brian Heater was the Hardware Editor at TechCrunch until early 2025. He has worked for a number of leading tech...

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WWDC 2025: Everything announced, including Liquid Glass, Apple Intelligence updates, and more

Lauren Forristal, Sarah Perez

12:21 PM PDT · June 9, 2025

WWDC 2025 kicked off Monday and as in previous years, the company focused on software updates and new technologies, including the next version of iOS, [called iOS 26](#).

This year, there was considerable pressure on the company to build on its promises and to [make amends to developers](#) as it lags behind in AI and faces continued legal challenges over its App Store.

iOS 26 is the most dramatic design change in over a decade

When Apple introduced a major overhaul to iOS back in 2013 with the launch of [iOS 7](#), it felt jarring for many users with the shift from the prior

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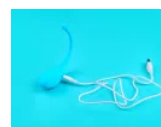
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skeuomorphic design with gradients and real-world textures to the more colorful, but flat, design style that reflected Apple's then chief design officer Jony Ive's taste for minimalism.

[At WWDC 2025](#), the company announced a [refreshed user interface called Liquid Glass](#), which features shiny, reflective, and transparent visual interface elements that give the software a more “glassy” look and feel.

The Liquid Glass display is translucent and will behave like glass in the real world. The color of the screen is informed by your content and will adapt between light and dark environments. In addition, alerts appear from where you tap, context menus expand into a scannable list when you scroll and tap.

The Lock Screen and Home Screen are [getting updates](#) that align with the overall aesthetic of Liquid Glass.

iOS 26, a new naming scheme

Instead of using system names like iOS 19 and macOS 19, [Apple will now use the year as part of the name](#). This means all its operating systems will be called iOS 26, iPadOS 26, macOS 26, tvOS 26, watchOS 26, and visionOS 26.

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A dedicated Games app

Apple unveiled a new [dedicated gaming app](#) that is designed to centralize gaming experiences on Apple devices. The app will serve as a launcher for games and allow users to track achievements and view leaderboards.

The Games app will also include social features, including a “Play Together” tab that lets you see what your friends are playing, compare scores, and invite them to play with you. There’s also “Challenges,” which is a new way to compete with friends in score-based showdowns.

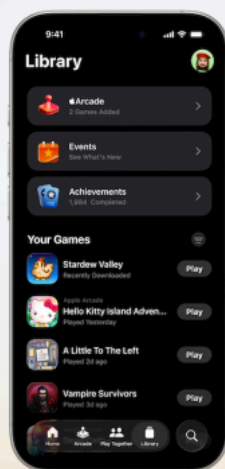


IMAGE CREDITS: APPLE

MacOS, iPadOS, watchOS, visionOS, and tvOS updates

Apple showed off [watchOS 26](#), the upcoming software overhaul for the Apple Watch. It will launch

with a redesigned interface based on Apple's new Liquid Glass operating system, a wrist-flick gesture, a new Apple Intelligence-powered [Workout Buddy fitness feature](#), and more.

Apple TV is [also getting a redesign](#), featuring a Liquid Glass aesthetic that offers a sleek and “unobtrusive” design, the company said. One of the standout features is the ability to quickly jump into a user profile. Apple TV will now present profile options each time it wakes from sleep, making it more convenient for each family member to select their profile and quickly resume watching their own favorite shows and movies. There's also a [karaoke feature](#).

macOS 26, [which the company calls Tahoe](#), is [getting some upgrades as well](#), in addition to the new Liquid Glass aesthetic will include an [AI-powered Shortcuts app](#).

iPad OS will make the [iPad feel like a Mac](#), including a new [Preview feature](#) that gives users a range of tools, including markup using Apple Pencil and AutoFill. Users can also export images in different formats.

And along with [updates to visionOS](#), Apple's Vision Pro AR/VR headset is getting [a couple of new accessories](#): a Logitech Muse stylus and PlayStation's VR2 Sense controller compatibility.

Updates to CarPlay and AirPods, too

While leaks suggested more gestures and other additions, Apple announced that the [AirPods lineup would be getting two key features](#): studio-quality audio recording and camera remote. It's also getting a camera remote.

Three of the [biggest additions to CarPlay](#) will be widgets and live activities, as well as the ability to choose a “tapback” response to incoming messages. Users will now also be able to pin their favorite conversations, just like in iMessage.

Apple Wallet, polls, Maps, and more

Other smaller features were announced as well, like new [travel-friendly features for Apple Wallet](#); [polls in iMessages](#); [lyrics translation and pronunciation features](#); and Maps will [learn your commute](#).

This story was originally published on June 5 and was updated significantly with all the announcements from WWDC 2025 on June 9.

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Lauren Forristal



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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Consumer News Editor



Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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